

THE BLACK DWARF.

No. 211

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

April 2026

In 1816, William Cobbett started a weekly paper called the Political Register. He wrote it in a simple way so he did not have to pay tax. It was cheap and easy to read, and lots of people bought it—about 70,000 by 1817.

Cobbett had been put in prison for speaking out against the government. He later went to America when his rights were taken away. His work inspired others to start their own papers.

In 1817, Thomas Wooler started a paper called the Black Dwarf. He used jokes and simple writing to criticise the government and ask for change. He got into trouble with the law but kept going with help from Richard Carlile.

The paper closed in 1824. Wooler later said he thought more people would support change than they really did.



THE CONSTITUTION PLACED IN ITS TRUE LIGHT.

Nothing puzzles an Englishman so much as the constitution of his country. It is harder than the enigma put to Edipus. So many things opposite in themselves, have been constitutional in their turn, that the constitution is every thing, and nothing—a blessing, and a curse—the offspring of immaculate wisdom—the produce of the weakest intellect.

The facts of the case are easily understood by a foreigner. The English were conquered by the Norman, William, and the country held long in vassalage, by the right of conquest. The wants of future Kings, and the growing progress of civilization, produced a contest between the people, who wished to be free, and the monarchs who wished to keep them slaves. As the power is *always* on the side of the people, when they choose to act; it followed as a matter of course, that when ever a single point was put to the test of the sword, the *people* were always ultimately victorious. But they wished for freedom, without knowing its first principles. They rose in arms against any grievance which they felt; and obtained a momentary redress. They did not combat tyranny generally but the effects of tyranny; they contented themselves with paring the nails of the royal tygers, instead of chaining them in their cells. The consequence was, that the nails grew as fast as they were pared, and a constant struggle ensued between the people, and the monarch. Every time the king was beat, came forth a new article of the constitution, which the king observed while it suited him, and broke as soon as

Trial by Jury

The King versus
THOS. JON^N. WOOLER.
VERDICT,
NOT GUILTY.

Charles Mawhood, Merchant.	William Hedgeman, Merchant.
James Bolland, Merchant.	George Billett, Merchant.
John Towell Rutt, Merchant.	Anthony Kennett, Merchant.
Thomas Smith, Merchant.	James Crow, Merchant.
Joseph Stafford, Merchant.	William Matthews, Merchant.
Benjamin Standring, Merchant.	James Plumsell, Merchant.

HAVE
Deserved well
OF THEIR
COUNTRY.